

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ 3 2

♣ 10 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♦

Pass

5♦

Pass

6♦

All Pass

6♦ by North

Now play ♦Q, ♦J, ♦9. Discard the ♠5 from dummy on the third ♦.

[showcards N:SQ,HA,H8 E:SJ,S9,H9 S:HJ,H7,D7 W:SK,HQ,HT]

East could afford to throw 2 ♠s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠K because you would throw the ♥8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥A and ♥J.

North is to play 6♦. East leads the ♥K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦s and 3 ♣s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that East must hold the ♥Q. If he also holds the ♠K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥s and ♠s.

You let the ♥K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

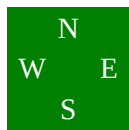
♠ A K J
♥ K 7 3
♦ A 6 5 2
♣ 8 6 4

♠ Q 10 9 3

♥ 10 5 4

♦ K J 10

♣ A K Q



♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2

♠ 6 5 4 2

♥ J

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ J 10 9 3

East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♣J. North wins

♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

North takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

North opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and South has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with North and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already rectified.

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

You plan to squeeze North by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to North.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. North is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

North is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

North can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not North.

If you discard the ♦6 North will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, North will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 5
♥ K Q J 7 5
♦ 9 2
♣ 8 4

♠ A 2
♥ 9 3
♦ A K 8 6
♣ K Q 10 6 5

N
W E
S

♠ K 9 8 4 3
♥ 10 8 6 2
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ -

♠ Q 7
♥ A 4
♦ Q 5 4
♣ A J 9 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6 ♣
All Pass			
6 ♣ by South			